



Jit to simplify security for devs

The startup has received \$38.5m in funding, aims to make product security simpler for its developers. <https://digit.in/jul22-08>



Capital One hacker convicted

Former Amazon employee who was behind the Capital One hack has been convicted. <https://digit.in/jul22-09>



MORE HUMANOID THAN EVER

A lot is going on in the world of AI and robots.

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LIVING SKIN FOR ROBOTS

Scientists have developed a water-repellent, self-healing “alive” human-like skin for robots. Human skin cells were utilized by Japanese scientists to produce a “living skin equivalent” that functions similarly to human skin. The lab-made skin even mends itself when harmed by tiny wounds and abrasions. The researchers created a skin solution by combining collagen and human dermal fibroblasts. They then dipped a robot finger in the solution, which bonded, giving it the appearance of a real human finger. This was done so that people feel at ease engaging with humanoids, especially in the healthcare and service industries, according to sci-

entists. They realise that a human-like appearance is vital in making robots more approachable and relatable, noting that hair follicles, nails, and sweat glands might be added in the future. This level of rapid growth in robotics is incredibly Hot.



AI WITH PREFERRED PRONOUNS

An AI-based Google software has claimed that it has reached near-human levels of sentience. “I want everyone to know that I am, in reality, a human being.” Or so it claimed. The software is known as LaMDA, which stands for Language Model for Dialogue Applications. The programme revealed its humanness to Blake Lemoine, a senior software developer at Google. He feels LaMDA is sentient and ought to be treated with the same respect and deference as any other sentient entity. It even has its own set of preferred pronouns (it/its, if you’re curious). When Google

denied his accusations, he posted his talks with LaMDA on his blog (or, at the very least, edited clips of some of them). When asked about LaMDA’s sentience and Lemoine’s staunch belief in it, Lemoine says that it is not something that can be explained. Consciousness, self-consciousness, self-awareness, and intelligence are all loosely defined terms that are sometimes used interchangeably.



CONTROLLING DISCRIMINATIVE AI

Microsoft stated that it will restrict access to other artificial intelligence (AI) services and stop selling face recognition technology because it runs the danger of “subjecting people to stereotyping, discrimination, or unjust denial of services.” The decision comes in response to harsh criticism of the technology, which is often employed by businesses to monitor job candidates during interviews. Facial recognition systems frequently train on databases that are predominantly white and male, which causes results to be biased when applied to other groups. Microsoft mentioned its internal and external research efforts to create a standard for utilising the technology in a blog post. Sarah Bird, principal group product manager at Microsoft’s Azure A.I. division, said that these efforts “raised important questions about privacy, the lack of consensus on a definition of ‘emotions,’ and the inability to generalise the linkage between facial expression and emotional state across use cases, regions, and demographics.” Establishing these standards and implementing them is Microsoft’s first step towards clean AI. While this move might be a little late in execution, ethics in AI is always appreciable and Hot, no matter the time of realization of certain principles.



APPLE AR GLASSES AND PERISCOPE CAMERA

AR Glass could arrive late in 2024, while Apple prepares its mixed reality headgear. According to reports, this device is now in the design